

SOP and POS

Sum-of-products ORs minterms where F is one

Minterms and maxterms

- A minterm is a product true on exactly one row, like $A'B$ for m zero on two variables
- A maxterm is a sum false on exactly one row, like $A+B$ for M zero
- Canonical SOP lists every one row; canonical POS lists every zero row
- That full form is not always minimal, you still simplify with grouping or laws

Browser lab

Digital Design and Verification Platform

HomeTools

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INTERACTIVE TOOL

SOP ↔ POS converter

Fill one truth table and read both **canonical SOP** (minterms) and **POS** (maxterms) — dual forms of the same function.

Starter example: 2-variable XOR — F=1 on rows 1 and 2. SOP is $A'B + AB'$; POS uses the zero rows' maxterms.

Load starter example

Challenges 0 / 22 cleared

Quiz: SOP: SOP uses rows where F equals? Answer: 1

Answer

Show hintCheckNextIdle

Quiz: SOPQuiz: POSQuiz: mintermQuiz: maxtermStarter XORDerive XORXOR POSPreset ANDPreset OR

All zeroAll onesToggle FQuiz: sigma3 variablesExplain dualQuiz: minimal?AND POSQuiz: m0

Quiz: M0Build NANDNAND POSFull dual

Core ideas

SOP
Sum of products = OR of minterms where F=1.

POS
Product of sums = AND of maxterms where F=0.

SOP POS starter

Workbook practice

- In the workbook track, take two-variable XOR
- Write canonical SOP from rows one and two, and POS from rows zero and three
- For AND, note only m three is one
- For all zeros, SOP is zero; for all ones, both forms collapse to one
- Name one pitfall: assuming canonical SOP is already minimal

Pitfalls to watch

- Do not mix SOP and POS rules, SOP uses F equals one, POS uses F equals zero
- Minterm m zero and maxterm M zero are different shapes
- And remember: the browser lab is literacy
- Real synthesis picks the form that fits your gate library and timing

Your turn

- Complete the checklist for at least one track, preferably both
- In the browser, finish a few challenges after the starter
- On paper, write SOP and POS for one small table
- When you are ready, take the short quiz, then continue to don't-care minimization